# Team Meridian - Indore First

*Case Prompt - Inter-University Strategy Challenge 2026, Round 2. VoltRide Mobility operates 1,800 dockless electric scooters in Pune and completed 410,000 rides in the last financial year. The founders must decide whether to expand into three tier-2 cities (Nagpur, Indore and Coimbatore) within eighteen months or to deepen operations in Pune by adding battery-swapping stations and corporate subscriptions. Teams must assess market attractiveness, unit economics per scooter, regulatory risk and the funding required for each option. Your submission must recommend one option, justify it with quantitative reasoning, identify the three largest risks and propose mitigation measures for each. Answers should not exceed 1,500 words excluding this prompt. Use only the case exhibits and publicly available sources, and cite every external source you rely on. Submissions will be scored on insight, rigour, feasibility and clarity of communication.*

## Recommendation

Team Meridian recommends that VoltRide expands into Indore first and keeps Nagpur and Coimbatore as a second wave. Indore ranks first in national cleanliness surveys, its central business district is flat, and its colleges are clustered along a few arterial roads, which makes a compact launch zone possible.

## Financials

Using the exhibit numbers, a 400 scooter launch in Indore needs about 2.9 crore rupees including the first year of operating losses. If utilisation reaches the Pune level by month nine, the city breaks even on a cash basis in month twenty two. We think that is acceptable because the brand becomes regional before competitors arrive.

## Risks

The first risk is regulatory. Pune Municipal Corporation has already capped dockless fleets in the old city wards, and a stricter parking rule could force us to build designated parking bays at our own cost. We would reduce this exposure by co-funding thirty marked parking hubs with the corporation and sharing anonymised trip data with its traffic cell, which turns the regulator into a partner rather than an opponent.

The second risk is battery degradation. Swap stations cycle batteries harder than overnight depot charging, and if pack life falls below eight hundred cycles the station economics break down. A leasing contract with the battery supplier, priced per kilowatt-hour delivered rather than per pack, moves this risk onto the party that understands the chemistry best.

Finally the third risk is execution: hiring a city manager who knows Indore. We suggest seconding two of the best Pune supervisors for the first six months.

## References

VoltRide Mobility Case Exhibits 1-4, Inter-University Strategy Challenge 2026.

Wikipedia contributors. Scooter-sharing system. Wikipedia, The Free Encyclopedia. Accessed October 2026.